

Northwind Analytics: Company Brief

Prepared for internal planning and agency briefing purposes. Q3 2026.

Company Overview

Northwind Analytics builds a product analytics platform for software teams: event tracking, funnel and retention analysis, session replay, and a lightweight experimentation layer, sold as a single subscription rather than a bundle of separate tools.

The company was founded in 2019 and has grown to 140 employees across offices in Austin and London, with a majority-remote engineering organization. Northwind is profitable on its Enterprise tier and is currently reinvesting that margin into growing the self-serve funnel, which remains the smaller of the two revenue lines by dollar volume but the larger by customer count.

Northwind's core differentiator against larger incumbents is time to value: a team can install the SDK and see its first funnel inside fifteen minutes, without a sales call. This is the plank the marketing and product teams have built the last two years of roadmap around, and it is the claim every campaign in market this year has been asked to reinforce in some way.

The company's most recent funding round closed in early 2025, a Series B, which extended runway through at least the end of 2027 and freed up budget for the campaign work described in this brief.

Northwind currently serves just under 900 paying customers across both plans, with a net revenue retention rate the finance team considers healthy for the stage but not yet best-in-class for the category. The customer base skews toward software and internet companies, with a growing secondary concentration in fintech and healthtech, both of which have shown a longer sales cycle on Enterprise but a comparable self-serve conversion rate to the base.

Product investment this year has focused on session replay quality and on a new experimentation module, both requested repeatedly by mid-market customers who had previously stitched together Northwind with a separate, more expensive experimentation vendor. Early usage data on the experimentation module is promising but not yet mature enough to feature prominently in outbound messaging.

Positioning

Northwind Analytics is positioned as the product analytics platform that a product team can stand up itself, in an afternoon, without booking implementation time with a vendor's solutions engineer.

The category is crowded. The two dominant incumbents are positioned around breadth: dozens of integrations, a warehouse-native architecture, and enterprise procurement muscle. Northwind concedes that breadth on paper and competes instead on speed to first insight and on pricing transparency, since neither incumbent publishes self-serve pricing.

Three messages carry the positioning across every channel:

1. **Fast:** a working funnel in the product in under fifteen minutes, not a multi-week implementation project.
2. **Honest pricing:** published self-serve pricing, no "contact sales" wall for a team under 50 seats.
3. **Built for product teams,** not for a central data or analytics team acting as a gatekeeper.

This positioning is deliberately narrower than the incumbents'. Northwind is not trying to win the data warehouse conversation, and sales is instructed not to compete on integration count. Where a prospect's primary need is a governed, warehouse-native analytics layer serving many departments, Northwind is not the right fit, and the sales team is expected to say so rather than over-promise.

Win-loss interviews over the last two quarters point to a consistent pattern: prospects who evaluate Northwind against a warehouse-native competitor and choose Northwind almost always cite time to first insight as the deciding factor, while prospects who choose the competitor almost always cite a pre-existing warehouse investment they did not want to duplicate. This is treated internally as validation that the "fast" message is the right one to lead with, rather than a reason to add warehouse-native capability defensively.

Pricing transparency has become a secondary but increasingly cited reason for choosing Northwind, particularly among Mid-Market buyers who describe the "contact sales" pattern at incumbents as a source of friction and distrust during evaluation. Marketing has leaned into this in the last two quarters of campaign creative, publishing pricing directly in ad copy rather than gating it behind a landing page form, a departure from how the category typically advertises.

Target Audience

Northwind's primary audience is **Mid-Market product teams in North America**: companies roughly 200 to 2,000 employees, with a dedicated product management function, evaluating or already running some form of product analytics.

Within that primary audience, the strongest fit is a product team of three to twelve people at a company that has outgrown spreadsheet-based or ad hoc analytics but is not yet large enough to justify a dedicated data engineering function to own a warehouse-native tool. That team typically reports to a VP of Product or a Head of Growth, and the economic buyer is usually that same person rather than a central IT or data organization.

A secondary audience exists in the United Kingdom, smaller in volume than North America but showing a healthier conversion rate on paid channels, which the campaign data should be read against. Enterprise accounts (over 2,000 employees) are pursued opportunistically through outbound and partner referral rather than through paid demand generation, and are out of scope for the campaign work this brief covers.

The buying trigger most often cited in win interviews is a product launch or a board-level push for better growth metrics, which is why campaign messaging leans on speed and clarity rather than on long-form educational content aimed at a research-stage buyer.

A smaller but growing share of inbound interest comes from product teams that have already adopted a competitor and are unhappy with either implementation time or unpredictable usage-based pricing. This "switcher" motion is not yet a formal campaign segment, but sales has asked marketing to consider a dedicated comparison-focused landing page for it next quarter, since the switcher buyer researches differently than a first-time analytics buyer and converts faster once they reach a sales conversation.

Persona-wise, the primary contact is almost always an individual contributor or lead-level product manager who will use the tool daily, not the economic buyer directly, which has implications for channel choice: content and webinar programs that reach practitioners tend to influence pipeline even when they do not directly drive a form fill, a pattern the attribution model does not currently capture well.

Products and Pricing

Northwind sells two plans. Self-Serve is priced per tracked user and available with a credit card, no sales conversation required. Enterprise adds SSO, a data residency option, a dedicated success manager, and a custom contract, and is sold through the sales team.

Plan	Monthly price	Tracked users included	Data retention	Support
Self-Serve	\$299/mo	Up to 50,000	12 months	Email, next business day
Self-Serve Plus	\$799/mo	Up to 250,000	24 months	Email, same business day
Enterprise	Custom, typically \$3,000 to \$12,000/mo	Custom	Custom, up to 5 years	Dedicated success manager, SLA-backed

Self-Serve and Self-Serve Plus are the two plans relevant to the mid-market campaign work. Enterprise pricing is included here for completeness but is not part of the self-serve funnel this brief informs.

A free 14-day trial is available on both self-serve plans with no credit card required to start, which is the primary top-of-funnel offer in current campaigns.

Goals for Next Quarter

Four goals are driving the marketing and campaign calendar for the coming quarter:

- Grow self-serve trial starts 25% quarter over quarter**, primarily through paid search and content, without a proportional increase in cost per trial.
- Improve trial-to-paid conversion on the Mid-Market segment specifically**, which currently converts below the blended average across all segments.
- Re-evaluate paid social spend**. Paid social has been a meaningful share of the demand generation budget for over a year; leadership has asked for a clear read on whether it is still earning its allocation before committing next quarter's budget.
- Expand UK presence** given the segment's stronger conversion rate, without yet standing up a dedicated UK sales or marketing headcount.

The table below is the working set of quarterly targets finance and marketing agreed at the last planning review. These are targets, not commitments; the campaign data should be used to sanity check whether they are realistic given current channel performance, not simply assumed achievable.

Metric	Current quarter	Next quarter target	Owner
Self-serve trial starts	~1,050/quarter	~1,310/quarter (+25%)	Growth marketing
Mid-Market trial-to-paid conversion	Below blended average	At or above blended average	Growth marketing + Product
Paid social share of demand gen budget	~22%	Re-evaluated, pending this analysis	VP Marketing
UK share of self-serve trial starts	~14%	~18%, without new UK headcount	Growth marketing

Any campaign proposal produced from this brief should speak to at least one of the four goals above explicitly, and should flag plainly where the available data is not sufficient to make a confident recommendation, rather than

filling the gap with a plausible-sounding guess.